PRODUCT DESIGN PLAN

The Simple Flash Sale Wizard

A guided, plain-language way to run a flash sale (□□□□) — built for sellers who are not techies, and for whom English is a second language.

The whole idea in one line: pick what is on sale, set one discount, choose when, see the real card, turn it on.

The wizard is a friendly front-door to the **same** flash sale the Flash sales page already runs — never a separate system, so anything made here stays fully editable later.
Two promises run through it: **plain words** (no jargon, short sentences) and **draft-first** (nothing goes live by accident — you choose when to turn it on). And one new power the old form never had: **many products at once, with the price math done for you.**

PART ONE — THE WIZARD

Run a flash sale in a few simple steps

Why this is simple — the levers

- **Pick a goal, do not build from parts.** Ready-made flash goals (weekend sale, clear out old stock, spotlight a few…) fill the products, the discount and the timing in.
- **Set a percent — we do the math.** Say “20% off” once; the wizard works out the new price for every product, so you never type a price for each one.
- **Pick many products at once.** A whole section, your best sellers, or tick them one by one — one discount covers them all.
- **Plain time, not a calendar puzzle.** “This weekend” or “tonight 6pm–midnight” becomes the exact start and end for you.
- **Smart defaults + draft-first.** Sensible values are pre-set; you can save a draft, schedule it, or turn it on now.

How it starts — the front door

One friendly question before any form:

What kind of flash sale?

Weekend sale · **Move old stock** · **Spotlight a few products** · **One product, quick** · **Start fresh** · **Ideas from my sales**

Each goal pre-fills the whole wizard, so it becomes a series of *confirmations*. Or use the **“just say it”** box — type “20% off all dried fruit this weekend” and the wizard picks the products, sets the cut, and chooses the dates.

The new part — many products, one discount

Today the Flash sales form does **one product at a time**, and it asks for the exact final price in yuan — so a “weekend sale on all dried fruit” means repeating the form fifteen times and doing the discount math by hand. This is the single biggest thing the wizard fixes.

The old form	The wizard
One product per save	Pick a section / your best sellers / tick many — one save covers them all
Type the exact flash price (¥73.60…)	Set one percent; each new price is worked out for you
No idea if it is really cheaper	Any product the cut would not actually lower is **skipped**, with a note
Prices look ugly (¥73.60)	**Round to nice prices** is on by default (¥73)

How it works under the hood (no new pricing engine): the wizard turns "20% off" into a real flash price per product (regular × 0.8, rounded), then saves each one the same way the form does today. The flash engine, the customer card and the countdown are all **reused exactly as-is** — the wizard only fills the boxes faster and for many products at once.

Ideas from your sales — the blank page, solved

The hardest moment for a non-technical seller is the blank page: *which* products, and *what discount?* Their own sales answer it. The wizard reads the shop's real numbers and offers a few ready-to-use ideas — each tied to a real figure, each one filling in the part the seller would otherwise have to guess.

Real number from your shop	What the wizard suggests (plain)	Fills in
5 products have not sold in 30 days	"Clear them out — 30% off for 3 days"	products + discount
Your best sellers are Goji & Dates	"Spotlight flash — 15% off this weekend"	products + discount
Friday is your quietest day	"Run a Friday flash, 6pm–midnight"	timing
A past flash sold out in 2 hours	"Run that one again"	the whole sale
A whole section is overstocked	"20% off all of Dry & Pantry"	products + discount

The honesty rule: every number is *measured from your real orders* — never invented. A brand-new shop with too little data sees the plain goals instead, with no made-up advice. And the wizard never suggests something the flash engine cannot actually do (see Part 3).

The flow — four small screens

Forks and extra rules appear **only** when relevant. Progress is shown as gentle dots — never a lying "Step 5 of 9."

Screen 1 — What's on sale

- **Pick the products.** Tick them one by one, choose **a whole section**, or grab **your best sellers** / **slow movers** in one tap
- A running tally ("12 selected") so a big sale never feels lost
- *One product, quick* from the front door lands you here with a single item already chosen

Screen 2 — The discount

- **How much off?** — Percent off (the default for many) · Money off each · Set one price (for a single product)
- A live table: each product's **was** → **now** and what the shopper saves — computed for you
- **Round to nice prices** is on by default; anything not actually cheaper is flagged and left out

Screen 3 — When & how many

- **How long?** — Tonight · This weekend · Next 24 hours · 3 days · Pick exact times. Shown back in plain words ("Starts Fri 18:00, ends Sun 23:59")
- **Limit how many at this price?** — No limit, or a number (adds an "almost gone" bar)
- **Can shoppers also use a coupon on top?** — one plain choice that replaces the "no coupon on flash" jargon, with the real effect shown

Screen 4 — Review

- A live preview of the **real flash card** the shopper sees — struck-through price, countdown, stock bar
- A one-line plain summary + the **smart heads-up** (Part 2)
- Three honest buttons: **Save as draft** · **Schedule it** · **Turn on now**
- An **"open the full editor"** door on every screen — the wizard is the simple mode, not a cage

Every setting → where it lives (nothing dropped)

Setting (today)	Plain name	Treatment	Where
product (one only)	What's on sale	**Pick many at once** — section / best sellers / one by one	1
flash_price	The new price	**Set a percent, math done for you** (or ¥ off / one price); rounded	2
flash_starts_at	When it starts	Plain time → exact start; blank = starts now	3
flash_ends_at	When it ends	Plain time → exact end; required, a past time is blocked	3
flash_stock_limit	Limit at this price	"No limit" default; a number adds the "almost gone" bar	3
no_coupon_on_flash	Coupon on top?	**One plain choice** — stack it, or flash price is final	3
flash_sold	Sold counter	Not asked — resets to zero on save; the heads-up explains it	auto
(turn on / schedule / draft)	Go live	**Draft** · **Schedule** (upcoming teaser) · **Turn on now**	4

Plain words, not jargon

The whole point is that a non-native English speaker can read it once and understand. Short words, no terms.

The old form said	The wizard says
Flash price ¥ (per product)	How much off? — 20%; we work out each new price

The old form said	The wizard says
Stock limit	Limit how many at this price (blank = no limit)
No coupon on flash	Can shoppers also use a coupon on top? — yes / no, flash price is final
Starts at / Ends at (date & time)	How long? — Tonight · This weekend · 24 hours · Pick exact
(you do the discount math)	Set the percent; the new prices are worked out for you

Safety nets for beginners

- **Not a discount → stopped.** If a “flash” price is not below the regular price, the engine ignores it — so the wizard catches it first and skips that product with a plain note.
- **Brand-new shop, no sales yet** → the “ideas” row stays quiet; the plain goals carry the flow. No made-up advice.
- **Never an error — prevent it.** A percent over 100 is capped; an end time in the past, or before the start, is blocked with a plain message.
- **Draft-first, nothing goes live by accident.** Nothing is written until you choose Schedule or Turn on; close the wizard and nothing happened.
- **“Open the full editor” on every screen** — the wizard is the simple mode, not a wall.

PART TWO — WHEN SALES & COUPONS ALREADY EXIST

The smart heads-up

A real shop is never empty. The moment that separates a toy wizard from a real one is what happens when you start a flash while other sales and coupons are already live. Before you turn anything on, the wizard reads your current flash sales and coupons and explains — in plain words — how the new one will behave next to them.

Every situation, in plain words

Grounded in exactly how the flash engine resolves things today — not invented behaviour.

Situation	What the system really does	What the wizard says
The flash price is not below the regular price	The engine ignores it — flash only applies when it is actually cheaper	“This is not a discount — ¥24 is the same as the regular price. Lower it or skip it.”
A product is already on a flash sale	There is one flash window per product; saving overwrites it	“Medjool Dates is already on flash until Sat. Saving replaces that window.”
A coupon is live and stacking is allowed	Flash and coupon stack — the coupon comes off the flash-reduced price	“With SAVE10, a ¥73 item becomes ¥65.70 — about 30% off in total. OK?”
You choose ‘flash price is final’	That line is removed from the coupon’s base, so coupons skip it	“Coupons will not apply to these items. The flash price is what they pay.”
This product had a flash before	The ‘sold’ counter resets to zero when the price or window changes	“The sold count starts again from zero, so a stock limit counts this run only.”
You set it to start later	A future start shows as ‘upcoming’ — a teaser, charging nothing yet	“Until Friday it shows a ‘starts soon’ badge. It is not hidden.”
You set a stock limit	When the limit sells out, the flash ends early — clock or stock, whichever first	“Ends when the timer runs out or 50 are sold, whichever comes first.”
End time is in the past, or before the start	The flash would never apply	Blocked: “That time has passed” / “The end must be after the start.”
A product has paid options (e.g. +¥5 spice)	The option price is added on top of the flash price	“The discount is on the base item; a chosen extra still adds on top.”
You choose ‘Turn on now’	Every matching product drops to the flash price immediately, for everyone	“From now on shoppers pay the flash price on these 12 products.”

How the smart heads-up decides what to warn about

It does not just *list* what is running — it works out, from your live sales and coupons, where the new flash collides:

- **“3 of these are already on flash”** — it checks every product you picked against live windows and offers to show you which ones will be replaced.
- **“With SAVE10, the real price is ¥65.70”** — it folds your live coupons into the preview, so the stacking surprise is shown before you turn it on, not discovered at checkout.
- **“Jackfruit Chips was left out”** — it names the products the cut would not actually lower, so a fake discount never reaches a shopper.

One honesty note carried from the engine: when “flash price is final” is on, the mini-app preview of a coupon can briefly over-show the discount until the app sends the coupon-eligible subtotal — but the *amount actually charged is*

always correct. The wizard says so plainly rather than pretending the edge case does not exist.

PART THREE — HONEST LIMITS + THE BUILD

What it is, and what comes next

What it should not promise yet

These are real seller wishes the flash engine cannot do today. The wizard deliberately **does not** offer them, so it never makes a promise that quietly fails — each is a future backend job:

- **Repeating flash sales** ("every Friday") — a product holds one window at a time; there is no recurrence. The wizard can set up the next one, but it cannot make it repeat by itself.
- **Buy-one-get-one / bundle flash** — a flash is a single-line price cut, not a "buy X get Y" rule.
- **A section that auto-includes new products** — the wizard flashes the exact products you pick; a product added to that section *after* you save does not join on its own.
- **A "below cost" guard** — the shop stores the selling price, not the cost, so the wizard cannot warn that a discount dips under your margin. (Add a cost field later and this becomes possible.)
- **Tiered flash** ("first 10 at 50%, next 20 at 30%") — there is one price and one optional stock cap per product.

One honest limit: there is no 'draft' switch for a flash

A coupon has an on/off flag; a flash does not. A flash is defined purely by its price and its time window, so "draft-first" here means something slightly different, and the wizard is honest about it:

Save as draft keeps the prepared sale in the wizard and writes *nothing* to the shop — safe, but it lives only until you come back to it. **Schedule it** writes a real *upcoming* sale (a visible 'starts soon' teaser) that you can undo any time with Clear. **Turn on now** makes it live. **Recommended small add:** a tiny 'parked flash' store so a draft can be saved and resumed later — a small backend change, flagged here, not built in this round.

What is reused vs. new

Reused (low risk — already built): the whole flash engine (active / upcoming / ended states, "is it really cheaper", the sold counter, the coupon-block rule), the product picker that the form already uses, the customer flash card with its badge / struck-through price / countdown / stock bar, the sales analytics behind the ideas, and the EN/CN language toggle.

New build	Effort
The wizard shell + 4-screen flow + the front-door goals	Moderate
Pick many products at once (section / best sellers / multi-tick)	Moderate
Percent → per-product price math + round-to-nice + skip-not-cheaper	Small
Plain-time scheduling ("this weekend" → exact start/end)	Small
The live flash-card preview inside the wizard	Moderate
The smart heads-up (read live flashes + coupons, explain collisions)	Moderate
Ideas-from-your-sales (read analytics, rank, phrase)	Moderate
A batch save endpoint, so many products go live as one all-or-nothing action	Small (backend)

Note on the batch save: there is no multi-product flash endpoint today, so the wizard would either save each product in turn (simple, works now) or call one small new batch endpoint (cleaner, and all-or-nothing if a save fails). Either way the per-product save logic is unchanged.

Suggested build order

v1 — the spine: front-door goals → the 4 screens → **pick many + percent math** → plain-time scheduling → live card preview → the smart heads-up (replace / stack / not-cheaper) → draft / schedule / turn-on. This alone turns “repeat the form fifteen times” into one guided sale.

Fast-follow: ideas-from-your-sales (the advisor), the “just say it” describe box, and the small backend extras — the batch save endpoint and the ‘parked flash’ draft store.

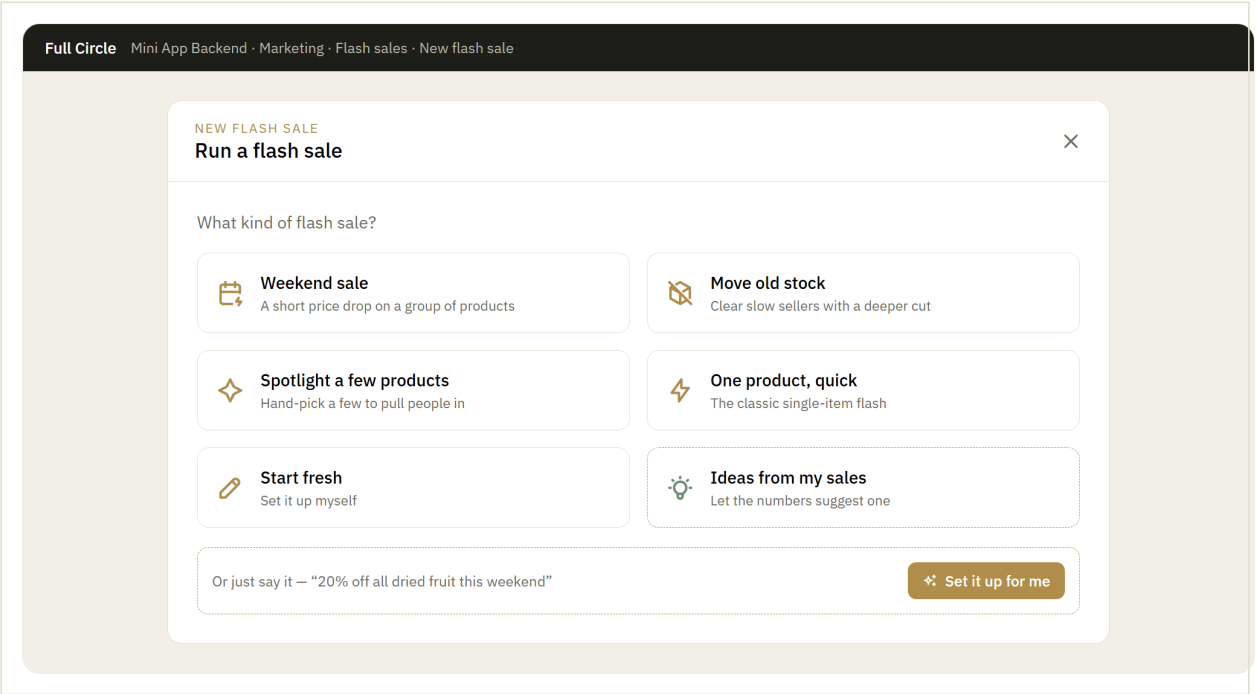
The Simple Flash Sale Wizard turns a one-product-at-a-time form into a single guided sale across many products — and, because it reads your live sales and coupons, it gives advice instead of just taking input.

THE SCREENS

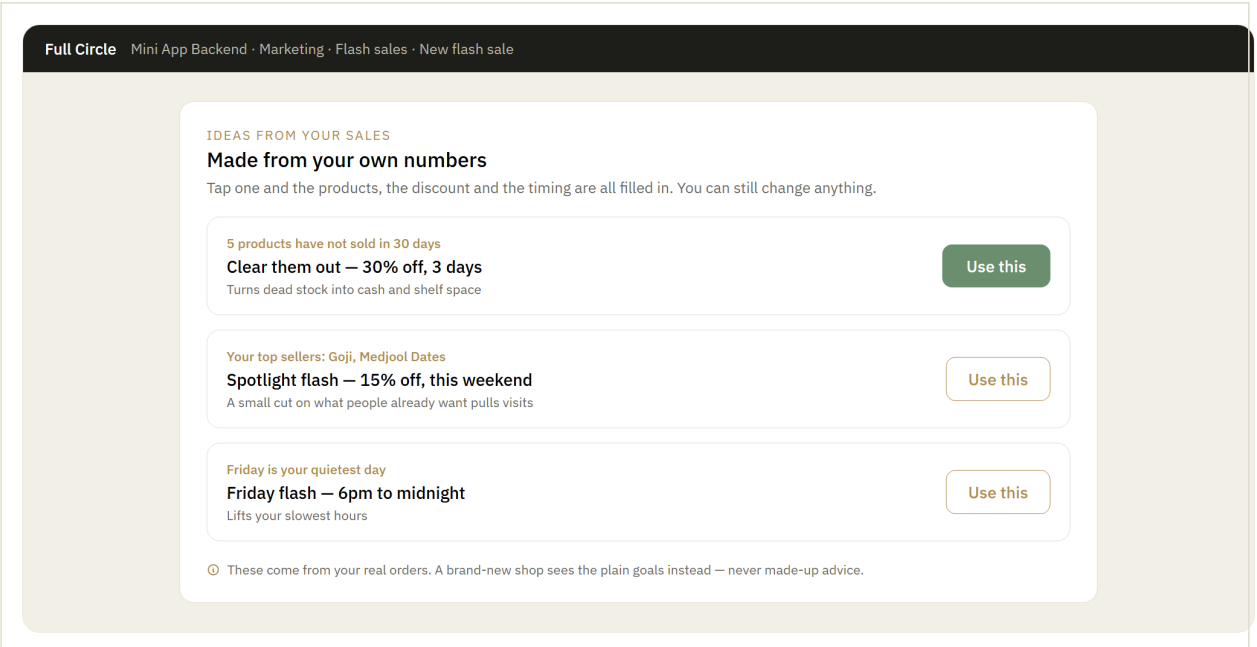
What it looks like

Mockups in the Full Circle backend palette (Ink / Brass / Tea, IBM Plex). The desktop flow has a step rail and a live preview that builds as you go; the same flow fits a phone for operators on the move.

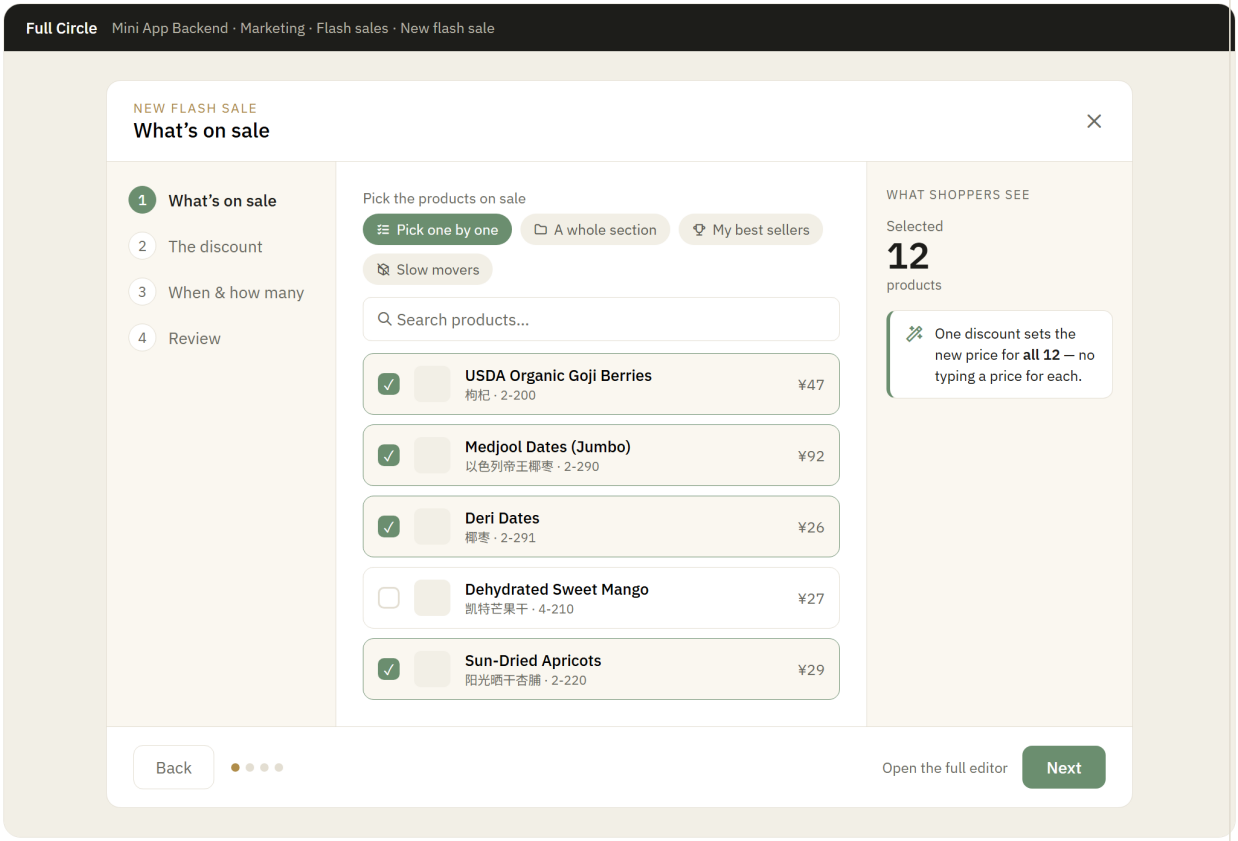
Desktop flow — screen by screen



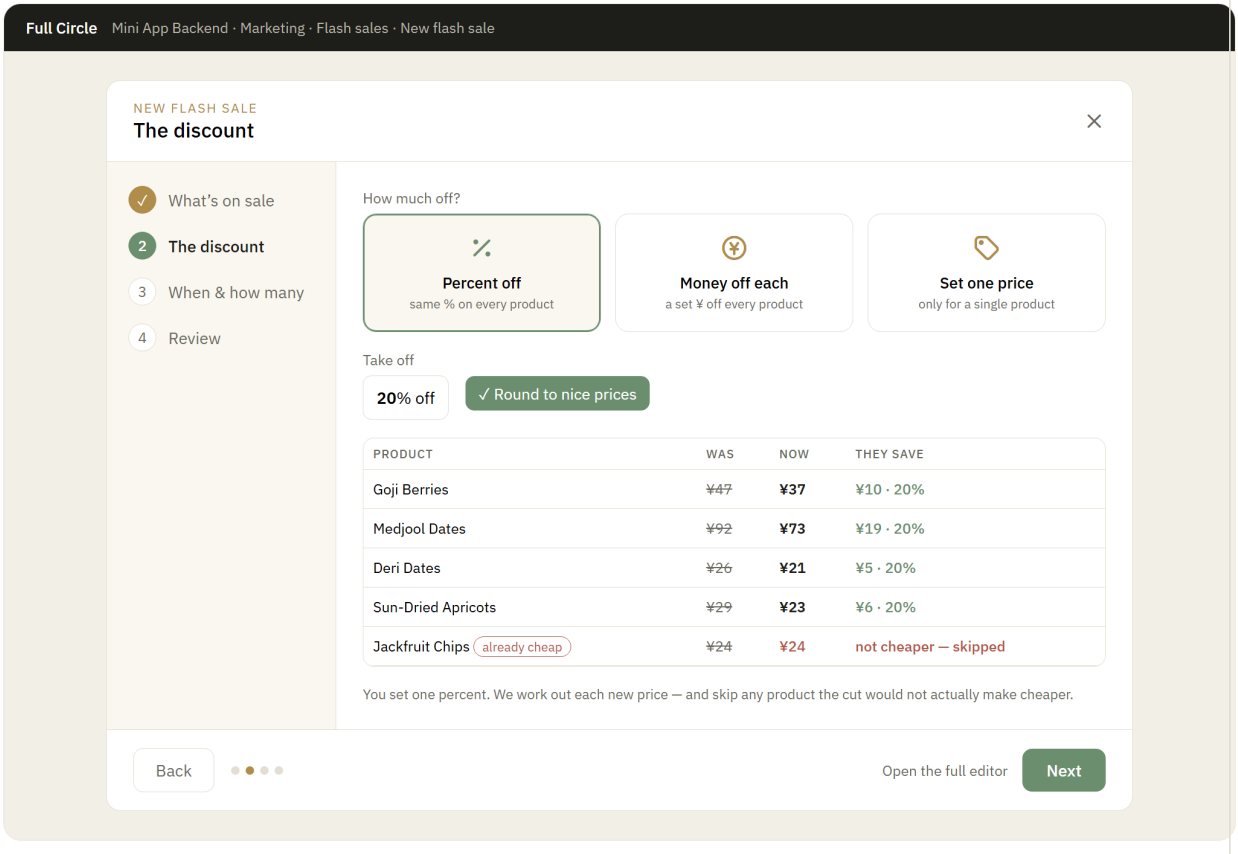
Front door — pick the kind of flash sale in plain words, or describe it in one line.



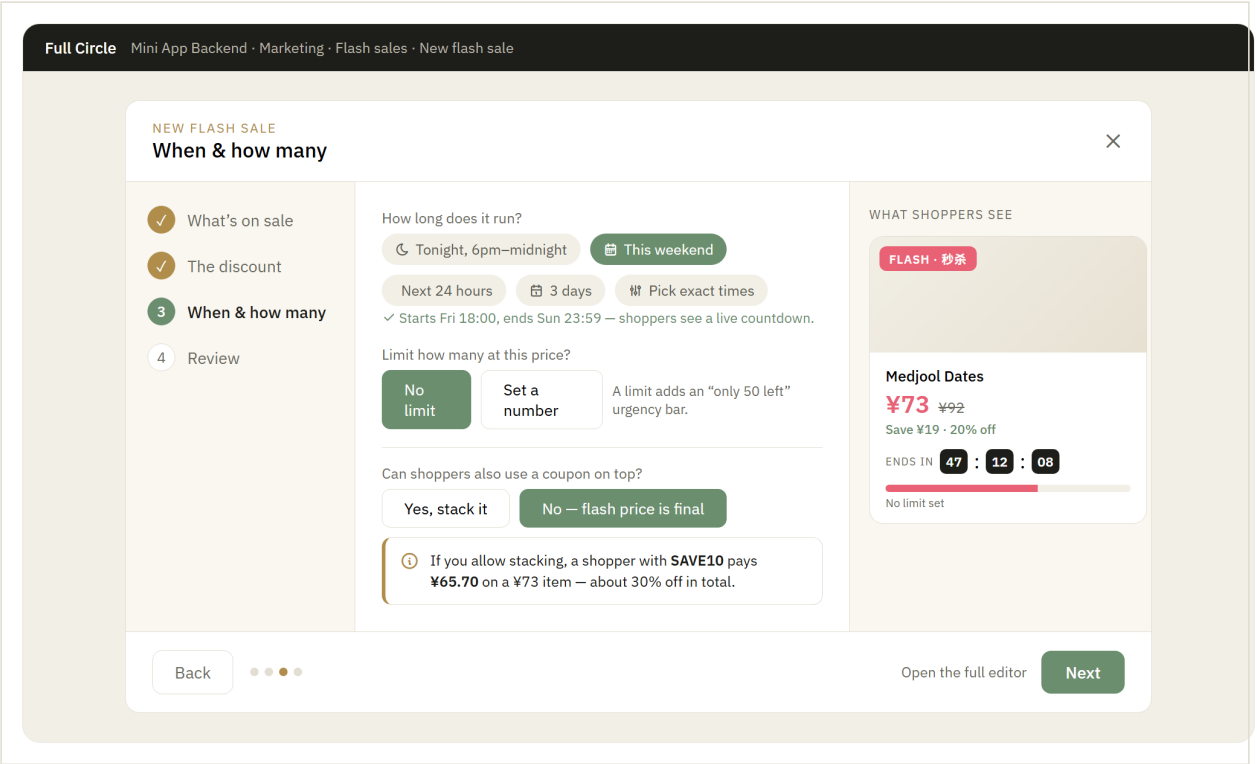
Ideas from your sales — the blank page becomes “pick a smart idea,” each tied to a real number.



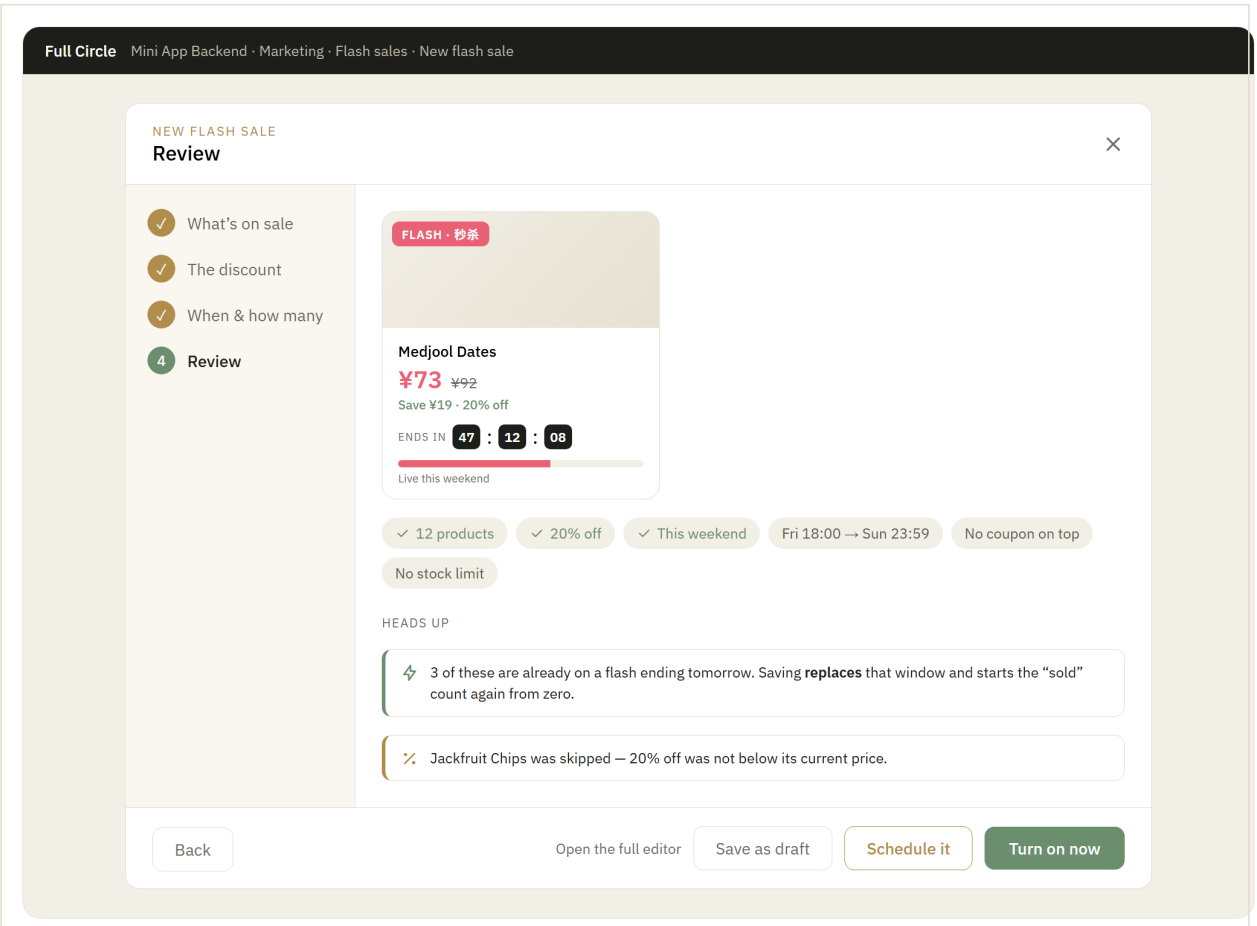
What's on sale — the new part: pick many products at once (a section, your best sellers, or one by one).



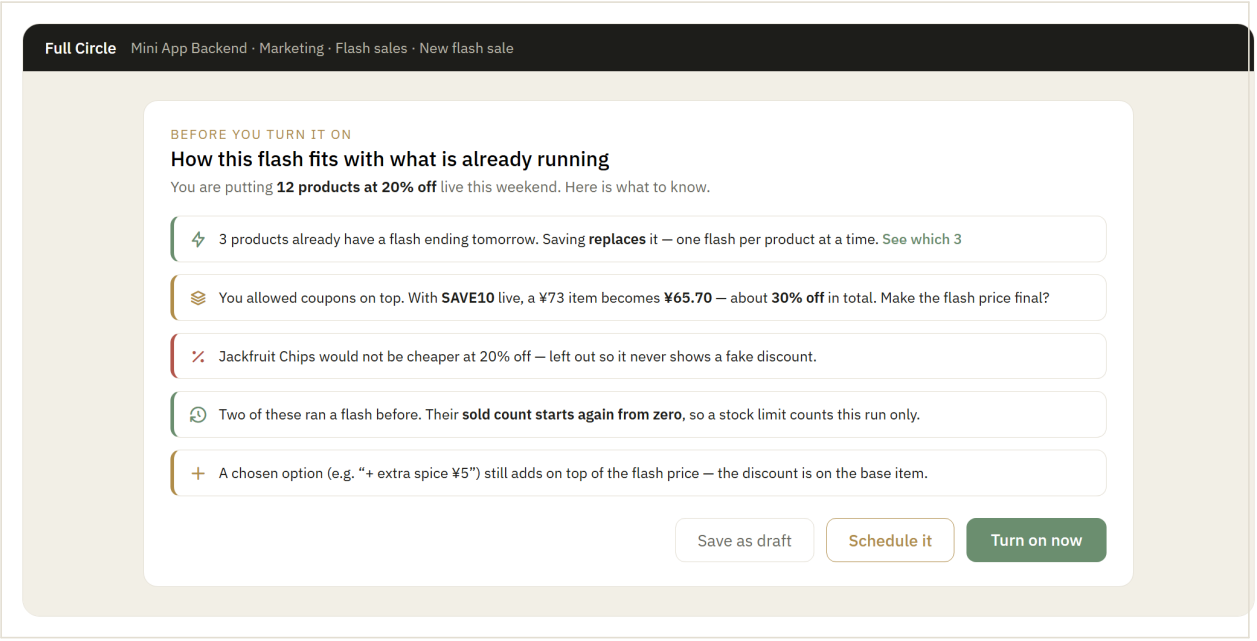
The discount — set one percent; the wizard does the math for every product and flags any that would not really be cheaper.



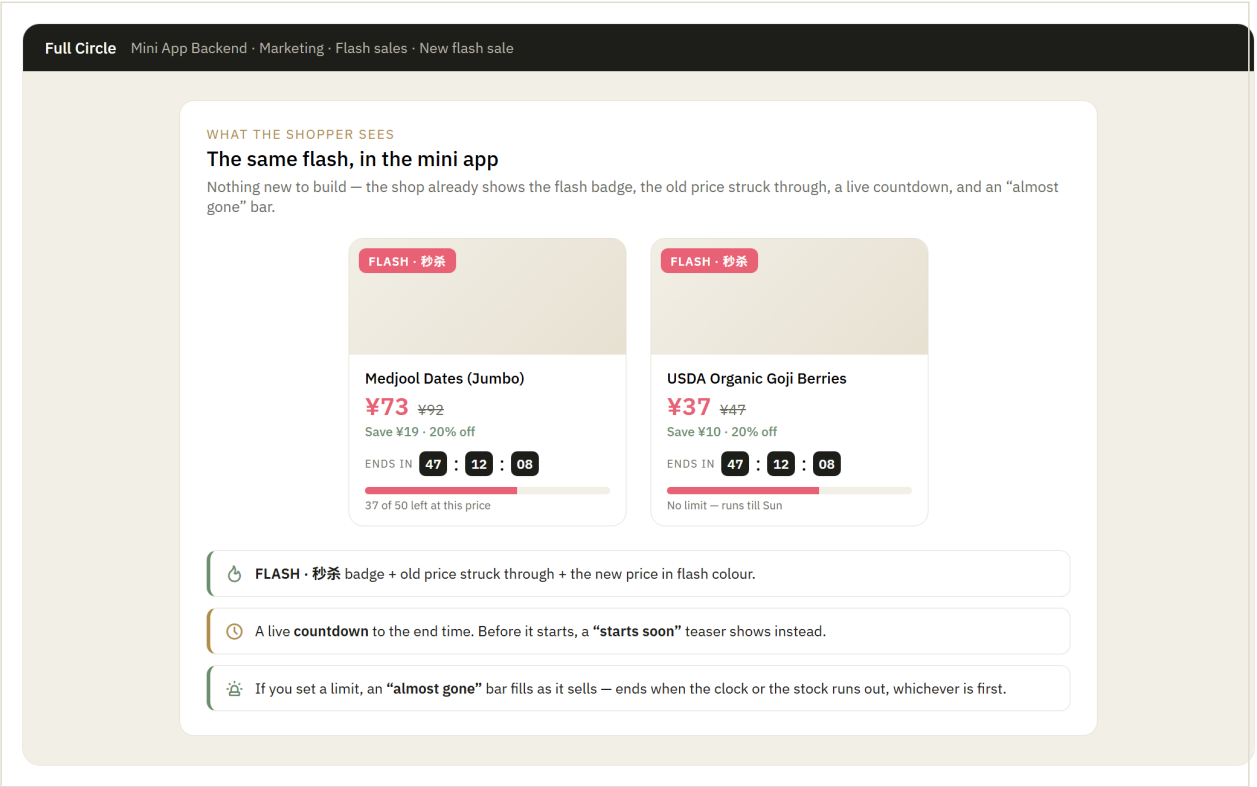
When & how many — plain timing ("this weekend"), an optional stock cap, and the coupon-stacking choice in plain words.



Review — the real shopper card, a one-line summary, plain heads-up, then save a draft, schedule it, or turn it on.



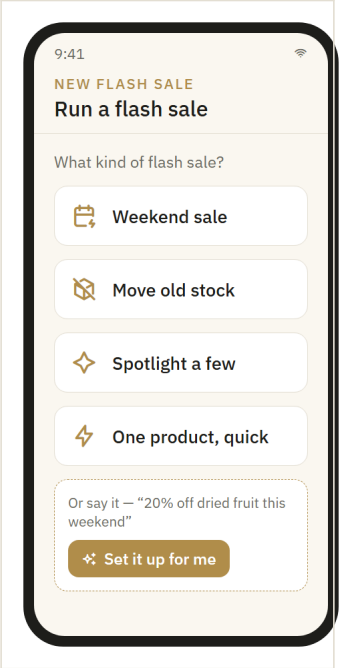
The smart heads-up — reads your live sales and coupons and says, in plain words, what gets replaced, what stacks, what resets, what is skipped.



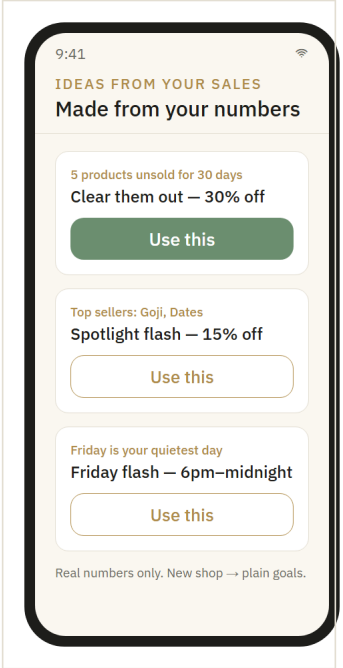
What the shopper sees — the flash card already exists: badge, struck-through price, live countdown, and a stock bar.

Phone flow — the same steps in your pocket

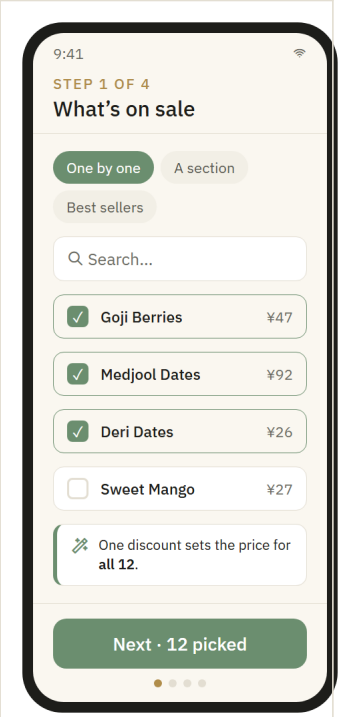
Each step on a phone, thumb-friendly — for operators running a flash sale on the move.



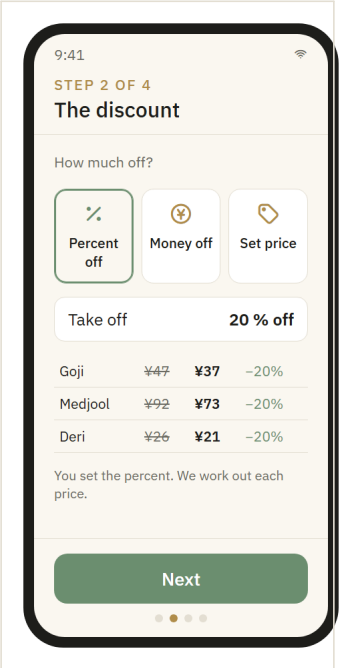
Front door



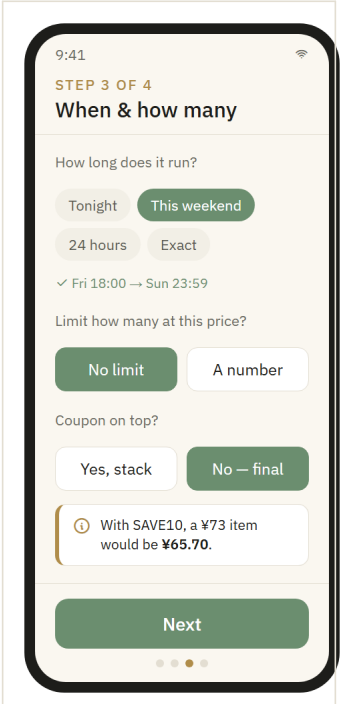
Ideas from sales



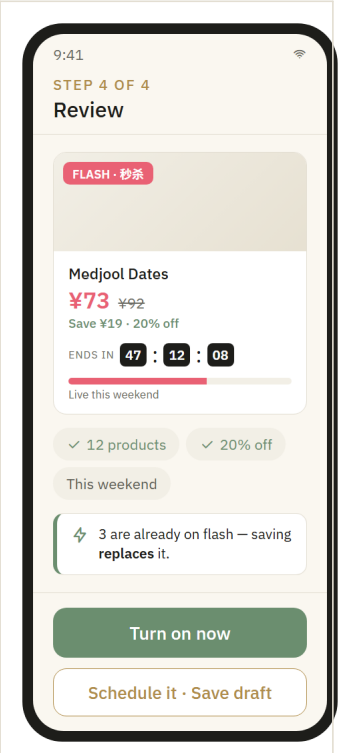
What's on sale



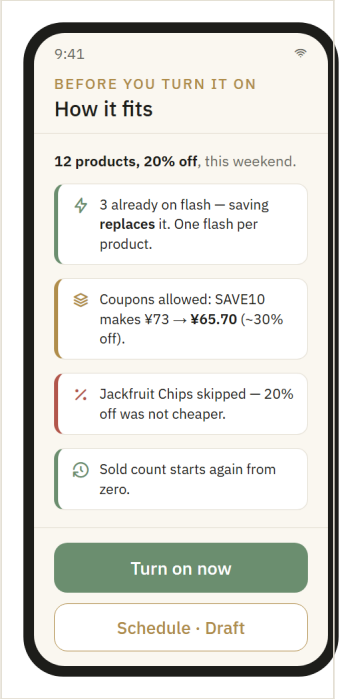
The discount



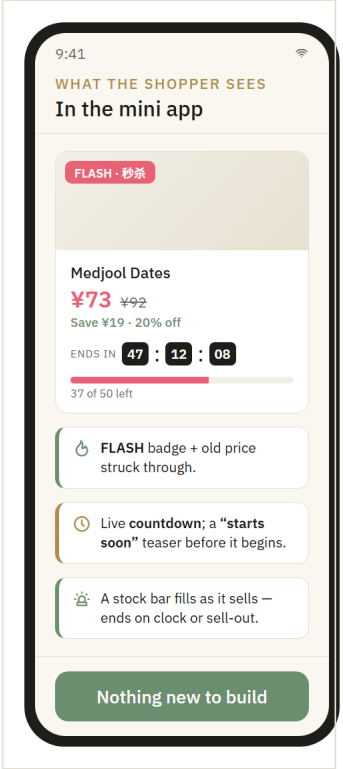
When & how many



Review



Heads up



What the shopper sees